LOBSTER SALAD

WITH SWEET CORN IN COOL ELDERBERRY BROTH

serves 2 to 4

One of the first times I met chef Sherry Pocknett, she was covered in lobster juices preparing for a big feast later in the evening. I never saw anyone break down lobsters so fast. This is a dish inspired by the time I met her, which was toward the end of the summer, when sweet corn was juicy and elderberries were ripe. It's served cool, and the sweet lobster and corn are accented with fried garlic, toasted pepitas, and a beautiful, light elderberry broth.

ELDERBERRY BROTH

- 4 ounces fresh or frozen elderberries (see Note), with or without stems
- ½ medium shallot
- 1½ tablespoons pure maple syrup
- Sea salt

SALAD

- Kernels from 1 ear sweet corn
- 3 tablespoons sunflower oil
- 2 garlic cloves, thinly sliced
- 8 ounces cooked lobster meat (from two 1½-pound lobsters; see Cooking Lobster, opposite), cooled and cut into bite-size pieces
- ¼ cup sliced scallions, cut on the diagonal
- 3 tablespoons toasted pepitas
- Sea salt

Make the elderberry broth: In a medium saucepan, combine the elderberries (it's okay to include the stems if they're attached), shallot, maple syrup, and 1½ cups water and bring to a boil over high heat. Reduce the heat to medium-low and simmer for 10 minutes, or until the berries are very soft. Press the berries gently to release some of the juice. Strain the liquid through a fine-mesh sieve (do not press on the solids) and let cool to room temperature. Season with salt.

Make the salad: Heat a medium skillet over medium-high heat.

Add the corn kernels, and cook for about 2 minutes, until charred in spots. Transfer to a plate and let cool.

Line a second plate with paper towels and place it near the stove. Add the oil to the skillet and heat over medium heat until it's warm. Add the garlic and cook for 2 to 3 minutes, stirring and tipping the skillet a bit to help the garlic fry in the oil, until the garlic is golden and crisped. Using a slotted spoon, transfer the garlic chips to the paper towels to drain and cool. Reserve the garlicky oil.

In a bowl, toss together the lobster, scallions, pepitas, charred corn, garlic chips, and garlic-infused oil. Taste and season with salt.

Mound the salad into the center of shallow bowls. Pour the cool elderberry broth into the bowls so it pools around and under the salad and serve right away.

Note: *If you can't find fresh or frozen elderberries, you can make this with 1 ounce dried elderberries and 2 cups water, but the elderberry broth will be less vibrant tasting.*